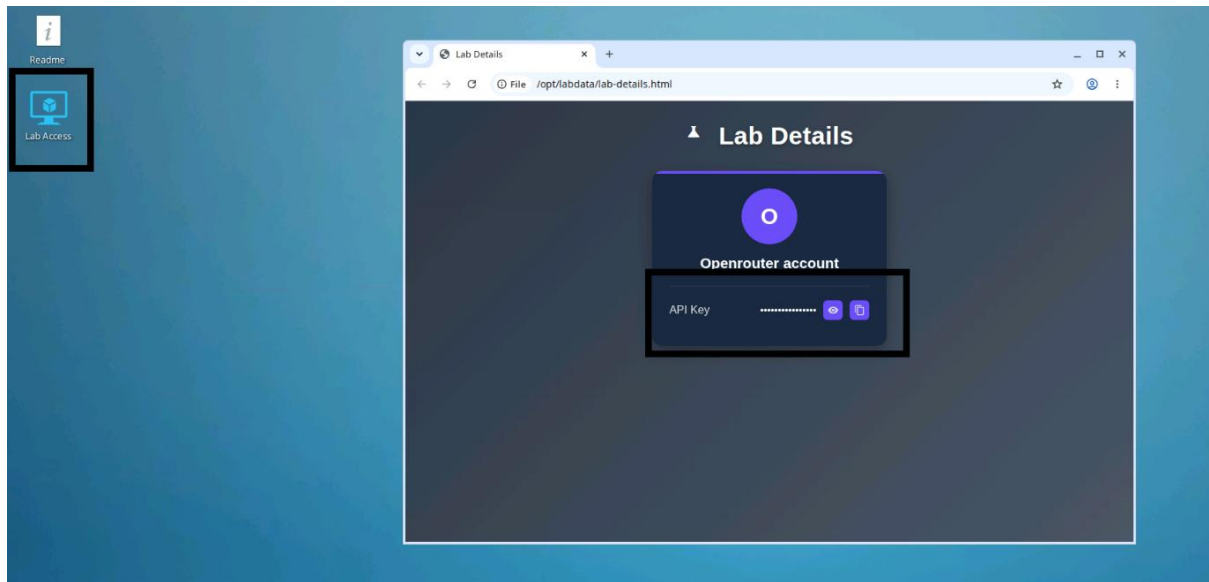
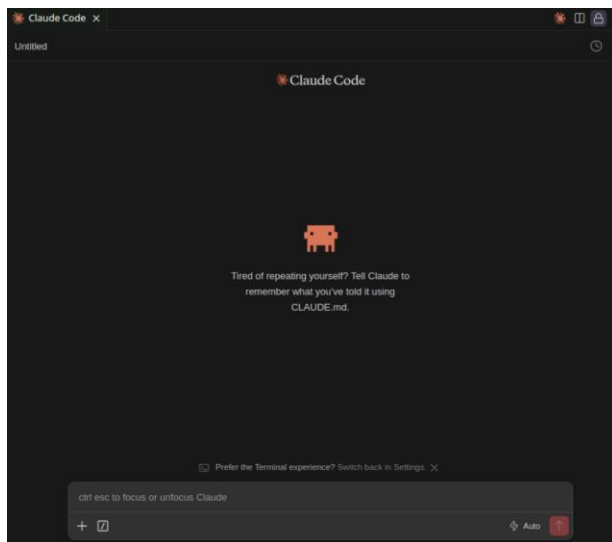


Guide to use Openrouter key instead of OpenAI or Anthropic API

The Openrouter API key will be present in lab details icon in desktop as shown.



The Openrouter API key is also configured in Claude code plugin in VSCode\



Using OpenRouter in Code

OpenRouter exposes an OpenAI-compatible API, so existing OpenAI SDK code works by changing only the base URL, API key, and model string. The key is read from the `OPENROUTER_API_KEY` environment variable. The model string is namespaced as `provider/model` (for example `anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5`).

Python (OpenAI SDK)

```
import os
from openai import OpenAI

client = OpenAI(
    base_url="https://openrouter.ai/api/v1",
    api_key=os.environ["OPENROUTER_API_KEY"],
)

resp = client.chat.completions.create(
    model="anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5",
    messages=[{"role": "user", "content": "Hello"}],
)
print(resp.choices[0].message.content)
```

Node.js (OpenAI SDK)

```
import OpenAI from "openai";

const client = new OpenAI({
  baseUrl: "https://openrouter.ai/api/v1",
  apiKey: process.env.OPENROUTER_API_KEY,
});

const resp = await client.chat.completions.create({
  model: "anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5",
  messages: [{ role: "user", content: "Hello" }],
});
console.log(resp.choices[0].message.content);
```

curl

```
curl https://openrouter.ai/api/v1/chat/completions \
-H "Authorization: Bearer $OPENROUTER_API_KEY" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{"model": "anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5",
  "messages": [{"role": "user", "content": "Hello"}]}'
```

Environment Variables

For tools that already speak the OpenAI protocol (Claude Code, Cowork, most SDK-based apps), the swap is usually just these variables:

```
OPENAI_API_BASE=https://openrouter.ai/api/v1
OPENAI_API_KEY=$OPENROUTER_API_KEY
```